***Board 1***
North Deals
None Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 5<br>♥ A K 6<br>♦ 7 6 3<br>♣ A K 4 2 | |
| ♠ J 8 3<br>♥ J 10 8 5<br>♦ K J<br>♣ Q 9 8 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 10 7 2<br>♥ Q 9 4<br>♦ Q 10 9<br>♣ J 10 7 |
| | ♠ 9 6 4<br>♥ 7 3 2<br>♦ A 8 5 4 2<br>♣ 6 5 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 2NT | Pass | 3NT |
| All Pass | | | |

3NT by North
Lead: ♠2

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠2, dummy plays the ♠4 and West the ♠J.

East plays low.

West wins with the ♦J.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=2 Total = 7

You need two more winners and dummy's ♦suit is your only hope. **IF** ♦s split 3-2 and **IF** the defenders don't take too many winners in their suit(s) you can establish ♦s by ducking twice.

Win the first ♠. If you hold up they might pocket the ♠ trick and switch to another suit where you only have two stoppers.

Next play a small ♦ from each hand. Win the return (probably a ♠) and duck a second ♦.

If the defenders can only take 2 ♠ tricks now you are home-free since dummy's 3 ♦s are now established.

You had to have the defender's ♠s split 4-3. But in fact you were pretty sure they were going to do so. Since East's ♠2 was probably his fourth-down then he couldn't have a fifth-down.

***Board 2***
East Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ J 9 8<br>♥ A 6 5<br>♦ Q 10 9 6<br>♣ K 9 5 | |
| ♠ A 7 4<br>♥ K 10 9 8 3<br>♦ J 5 3<br>♣ Q 3 | | ♠ K 6 3<br>♥ Q J<br>♦ A K 4 2<br>♣ A 10 6 4 |
| | ♠ Q 10 5 2<br>♥ 7 4 2<br>♦ 8 7<br>♣ J 8 7 2 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | | 1NT | Pass |
| 2♦ | Pass | 2♥ | Pass |
| 3NT | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

3NT by East
Lead: ♠2

West's 3♦ bid was a transfer to ♥s. East is to play 3NT. South leads the ♠2.

North plays the ♠J and you win with the ♠K.

South plays low.

North plays low too.

South plays low.

North holds up his ♥A again.

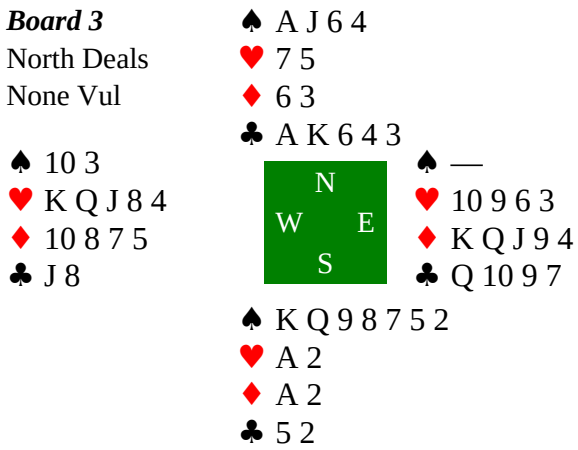
Winners: ♠=2 ♥=0 ♦=2 ♣=1 Total = 5

Obviously you need to establish 4 ♥ winners and by driving out the ♥A you can manage that handily. The problem is that dummy has only one sure entry, (the ♠A), and the defenders may be good enough to hold up their ♥A twice.

To assure the contract you should win the first trick in your hand with the ♠K. Then play ♥Q, ♥J overtaking with dummy's ♥K so you can continue establishing the suit while you still have that ♠ entry.

None of the other suits were sitting well so overtaking the ♥ was the way to go.

***Board 3***
North Deals
None Vul




| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| | 1♣ | Pass | 1♠ |
| Pass | 2♠ | Pass | 4NT[1] |
| Pass | 5♥[2] | Pass | 6♠ |
| All Pass | | | |

1. Blackwood
2. 2 aces

6♠ by South
Lead: ♥K

South is to play 6♠. West leads the ♥K, dummy plays the ♥5 and East the ♥3.

You win the ♥A and draw trumps with the ♠K and ♠Q.

West plays low.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

One of the two red losers must be discarded on dummy's ♣ suit. So you pull trumps, taking two rounds, with ♠K and ♠Q. Then play two top ♣s and ruff a ♣. When West shows out on the third ♣, enter dummy with a trump and ruff another ♣. Dummy's final ♣ is now established, so enter dummy with another trump and discard one of the red losers on the fifth ♣.

As long as the ♣s were no worse than 4-2 you can establish the suit.

***Board 4***
West Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K 6 4 3<br>♥ 9 7<br>♦ K 10 8 6 2<br>♣ 8 2 | |
| ♠ Q J 5<br>♥ K 5 4 3<br>♦ A 4 3<br>♣ A K 5 | | ♠ 10 9 7 2<br>♥ A J 6<br>♦ 7 5<br>♣ Q 6 4 3 |
| | ♠ A 8<br>♥ Q 10 8 2<br>♦ Q J 9<br>♣ J 10 9 7 | |

| *West* | *North* | *East* | *South* |
|---|---|---|---|
| 1NT | | | |
| All Pass | | | |

1NT by West
Lead: ♦6

West is to play 1NT. North leads the ♦6, taken by South with the ♦J. South next plays the ♦Q on which North plays the ♦2. South plays the ♦9 which you finally win.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

You only need one more winner and you have several possibilities. The ♥ finesse might work, or the ♣s might split 3-3. But you need to consider the defenders winners also. They have already scored 2 ♦ tricks and will get 2 more as soon as they gain the lead. (The spot cards told you that North has a 5-card ♦ suit.) Plus they have the 2 top ♠s which they can take whenever they like. So if your play sets up just one more trick for them you will go down.

No, you must establish ♠s, the suit where they have 2 winners anyway. So you play a ♠ which North wins. He takes his 2 ♦s but you are now home free. When you gain the lead again you will get your ♠ winner established and only lose 2 ♠s and 4 ♦s.

If you finessed the ♥ you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦s, 1 ♥ and 2 ♠s.

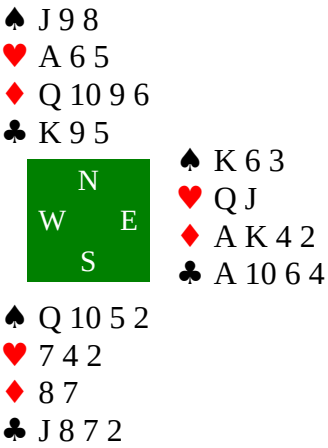
If you had played 3 rounds of ♣s you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦s, 1 ♣ and 2 ♠s.

Only by establishing ♠s can you make the contract.

***Board 5***
North Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 5<br>♥ A K 6<br>♦ 7 6 3<br>♣ A K 4 2 | |
| ♠ J 8 3<br>♥ J 10 8 5<br>♦ K J<br>♣ Q 9 8 3 | | ♠ Q 10 7 2<br>♥ Q 9 4<br>♦ Q 10 9<br>♣ J 10 7 |
| | ♠ 9 6 4<br>♥ 7 3 2<br>♦ A 8 5 4 2<br>♣ 6 5 | |

***Board 6***
East Deals
E-W Vul



***Board 7***
South Deals
Both Vul

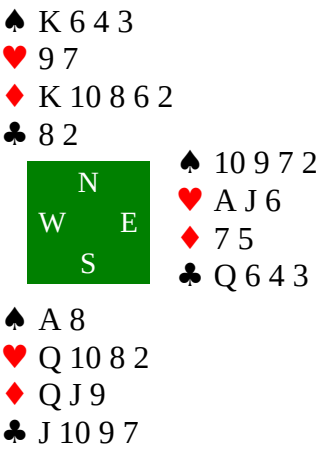
♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

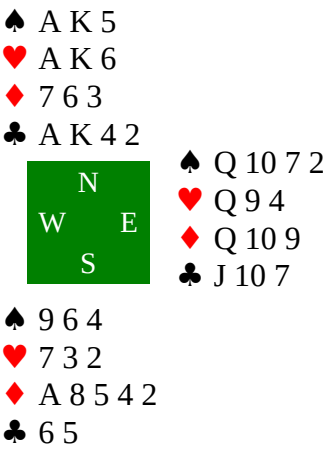
♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 8***
West Deals
None Vul



***Board 9***
North Deals
E-W Vul



***Board 10***
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 9 8
♥ A 6 5
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ K 9 5

♠ A 7 4
♥ K 10 9 8 3
♦ J 5 3
♣ Q 3

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q J
♦ A K 4 2
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
♥ 7 4 2
♦ 8 7
♣ J 8 7 2

***Board 11***
South Deals
None Vul

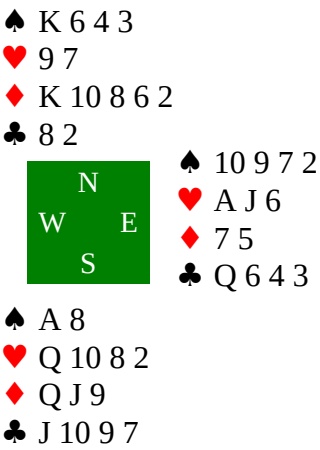
♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 12***
West Deals
N-S Vul



***Board 13***
North Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 5<br>♥ A K 6<br>♦ 7 6 3<br>♣ A K 4 2 | |
| ♠ J 8 3<br>♥ J 10 8 5<br>♦ K J<br>♣ Q 9 8 3 | | ♠ Q 10 7 2<br>♥ Q 9 4<br>♦ Q 10 9<br>♣ J 10 7 |
| | ♠ 9 6 4<br>♥ 7 3 2<br>♦ A 8 5 4 2<br>♣ 6 5 | |

***Board 14***
East Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 8
♥ A 6 5
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ K 9 5

♠ A 7 4
♥ K 10 9 8 3
♦ J 5 3
♣ Q 3

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q J
♦ A K 4 2
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
♥ 7 4 2
♦ 8 7
♣ J 8 7 2

***Board 15***
South Deals
N-S Vul

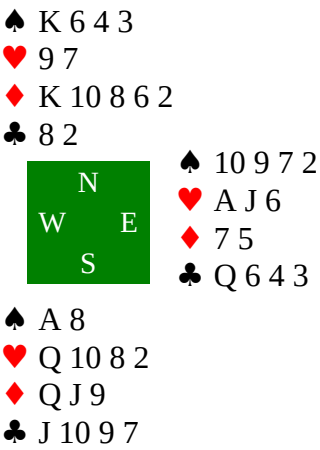
♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 16***
West Deals
E-W Vul



***Board 17***
North Deals
None Vul

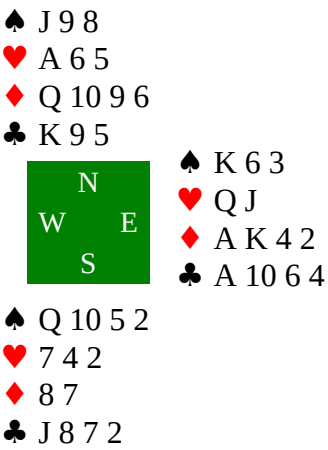
♠ A K 5
♥ A K 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 4 2

♠ J 8 3
♥ J 10 8 5
♦ K J
♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ Q 10 7 2
♥ Q 9 4
♦ Q 10 9
♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4
♥ 7 3 2
♦ A 8 5 4 2
♣ 6 5

***Board 18***
East Deals
N-S Vul



***Board 19***
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 20***
West Deals
Both Vul

♠ K 6 4 3
♥ 9 7
♦ K 10 8 6 2
♣ 8 2

♠ Q J 5
♥ K 5 4 3
♦ A 4 3
♣ A K 5

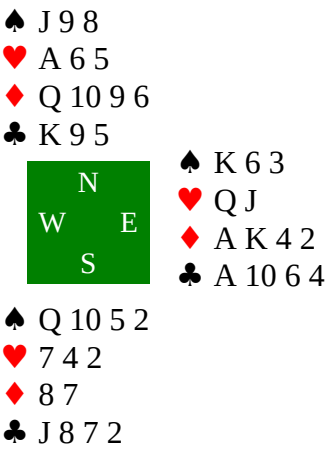
♠ 10 9 7 2
♥ A J 6
♦ 7 5
♣ Q 6 4 3

♠ A 8
♥ Q 10 8 2
♦ Q J 9
♣ J 10 9 7

***Board 21***
North Deals
N-S Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 5<br>♥ A K 6<br>♦ 7 6 3<br>♣ A K 4 2 | |
| ♠ J 8 3<br>♥ J 10 8 5<br>♦ K J<br>♣ Q 9 8 3 | | ♠ Q 10 7 2<br>♥ Q 9 4<br>♦ Q 10 9<br>♣ J 10 7 |
| | ♠ 9 6 4<br>♥ 7 3 2<br>♦ A 8 5 4 2<br>♣ 6 5 | |

***Board 22***
East Deals
E-W Vul



***Board 23***
South Deals
Both Vul

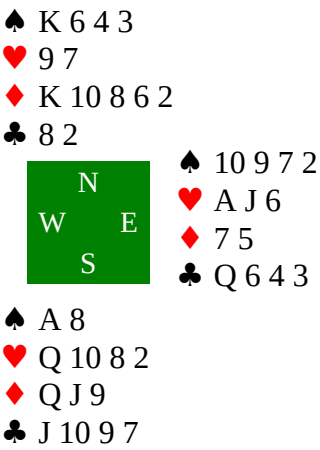
♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 24***
West Deals
None Vul



***Board 25***
North Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A K 5
♥ A K 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 4 2

♠ J 8 3
♥ J 10 8 5
♦ K J
♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ Q 10 7 2
♥ Q 9 4
♦ Q 10 9
♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4
♥ 7 3 2
♦ A 8 5 4 2
♣ 6 5

***Board 26***
East Deals
Both Vul

♠ J 9 8
♥ A 6 5
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ K 9 5

♠ A 7 4
♥ K 10 9 8 3
♦ J 5 3
♣ Q 3

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q J
♦ A K 4 2
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
♥ 7 4 2
♦ 8 7
♣ J 8 7 2

***Board 27***
South Deals
None Vul

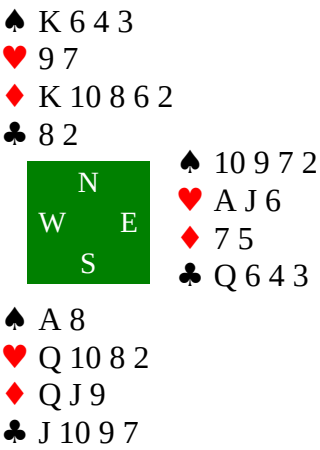
♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 28***
West Deals
N-S Vul



***Board 29***
North Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ A K 5<br>♥ A K 6<br>♦ 7 6 3<br>♣ A K 4 2 | |
| ♠ J 8 3<br>♥ J 10 8 5<br>♦ K J<br>♣ Q 9 8 3 | N<br>W E<br>S | ♠ Q 10 7 2<br>♥ Q 9 4<br>♦ Q 10 9<br>♣ J 10 7 |
| | ♠ 9 6 4<br>♥ 7 3 2<br>♦ A 8 5 4 2<br>♣ 6 5 | |

***Board 30***
East Deals
None Vul

♠ J 9 8
♥ A 6 5
♦ Q 10 9 6
♣ K 9 5

♠ A 7 4
♥ K 10 9 8 3
♦ J 5 3
♣ Q 3

♠ K 6 3
♥ Q J
♦ A K 4 2
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ Q 10 5 2
♥ 7 4 2
♦ 8 7
♣ J 8 7 2

***Board 31***
South Deals
N-S Vul

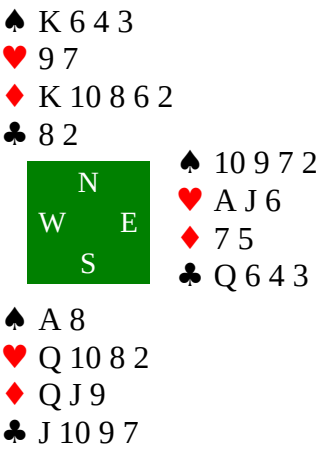
♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 32***
West Deals
E-W Vul



***Board 33***
North Deals
None Vul

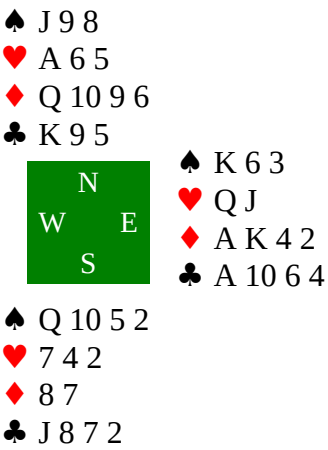
♠ A K 5
♥ A K 6
♦ 7 6 3
♣ A K 4 2

♠ J 8 3
♥ J 10 8 5
♦ K J
♣ Q 9 8 3

♠ Q 10 7 2
♥ Q 9 4
♦ Q 10 9
♣ J 10 7

♠ 9 6 4
♥ 7 3 2
♦ A 8 5 4 2
♣ 6 5

***Board 34***
East Deals
N-S Vul



***Board 35***
South Deals
E-W Vul

♠ A J 6 4
♥ 7 5
♦ 6 3
♣ A K 6 4 3

♠ 10 3
♥ K Q J 8 4
♦ 10 8 7 5
♣ J 8

♠ —
♥ 10 9 6 3
♦ K Q J 9 4
♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2
♥ A 2
♦ A 2
♣ 5 2

***Board 36***
West Deals
Both Vul

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| | ♠ K 6 4 3<br>♥ 9 7<br>♦ K 10 8 6 2<br>♣ 8 2 | |
| ♠ Q J 5<br>♥ K 5 4 3<br>♦ A 4 3<br>♣ A K 5 | | ♠ 10 9 7 2<br>♥ A J 6<br>♦ 7 5<br>♣ Q 6 4 3 |
| | ♠ A 8<br>♥ Q 10 8 2<br>♦ Q J 9<br>♣ J 10 9 7 | |